D.J. PARIS

ONE LENDER QUOTE IS JUST A GUESS.

A better lender can be worth $5,800 more house.

D.J. Paris
Keeping It Real Podcast

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YOUR BUYER'S "TRUSTED LENDER" MIGHT BE THE EXPENSIVE ONE. THEY'LL NEVER KNOW WITH ONE QUOTE.

Realtor.com found the gap between lenders can run $5,800 in buying power.

THE RATE ISN'T THE WHOLE STORY. THE TOTAL COST IS.

Realtor.com's October 2026 mortgage-rate report, built on Freddie Mac's loan-level data covering more than 1.3 million purchase loans from 2023 to 2025, found the difference between a typical retail lender and a very competitive one was about 19 basis points. On a $2,000 monthly principal-and-interest budget, that gap is worth roughly $5,800 in buying power. A single quote gives a buyer no way to tell which kind of lender they're looking at.

WHAT TO TELL EVERY BUYER BEFORE THEY PICK A LENDER:

1 **Get a Loan Estimate from three different lenders, the same week.**
This is the lender's official federal cost sheet, not a verbal quote.

2 **Lay the three side by side.**
Compare the rate and the total cost, not just the rate on top.

3 **Don't drop a trusted lender. Make them compete.**
The point is comparison, not loyalty. A trusted lender who's also competitive will show it on paper.

THE TAKEAWAY

THREE LOAN ESTIMATES, ONE WEEK, BEFORE ANYONE SIGNS ANYTHING.

Make your buyer compare lenders before they pick one.

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